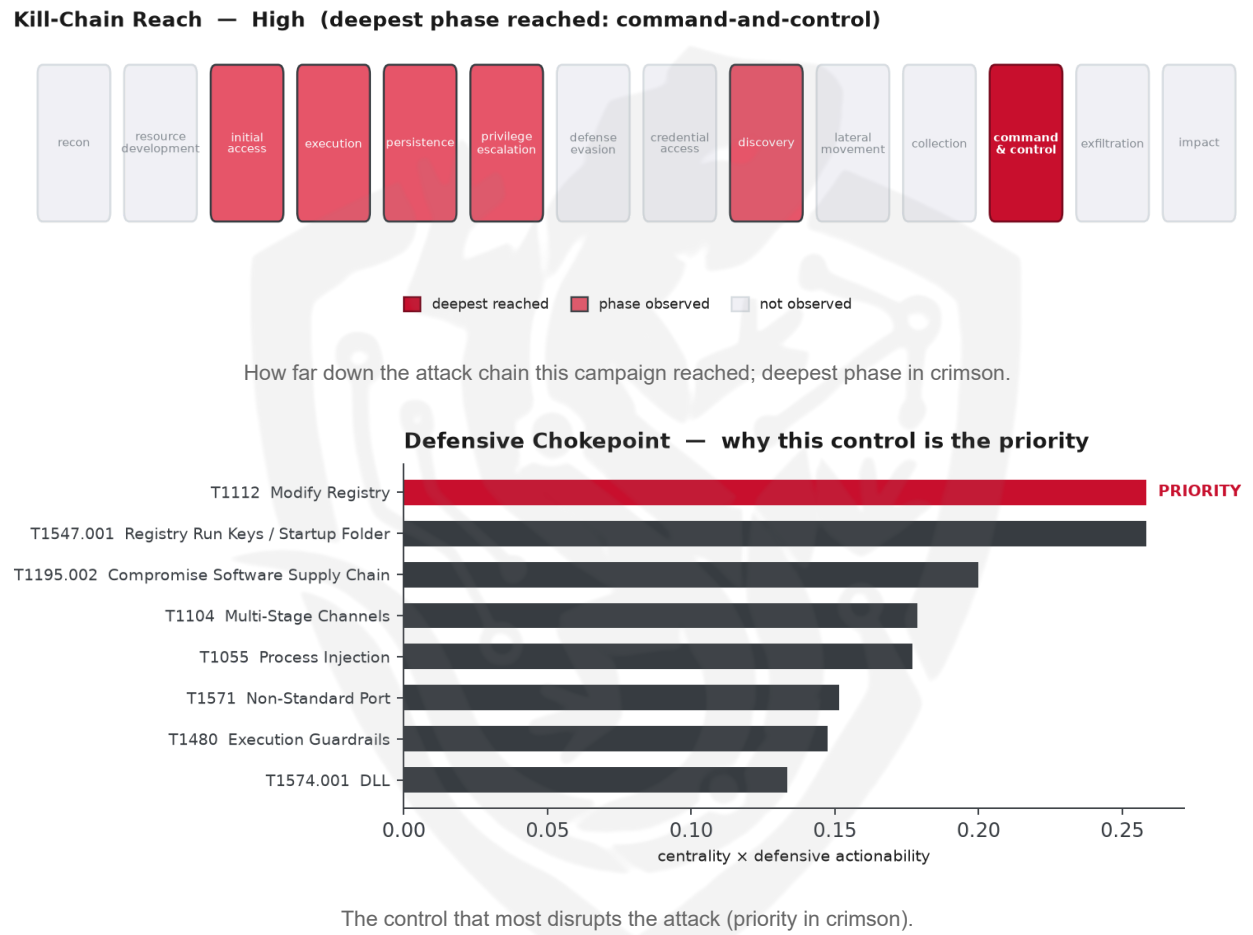


THREAT REPORT: QUICKFOX SUPPLY CHAIN ATTACK DEPLOYS FDMTP IMPLANT

Visual Summary



Summary

The observed cluster of activity has been identified as a QuickFox supply chain attack, which is used to deploy the FDMTP implant. The targeted entities and countries are not specified, but the attack is considered high-risk due to its ability to reach command-and-control levels. Priority should be given to monitoring sensitive registry keys for modification and restricting registry-edit tools for unprivileged users. The attack's use of various techniques, including system owner discovery and process injection, allows it to maintain a strong presence within the targeted systems.

Threat Overview

The threat actor, whose identity is not specified, is utilizing the FDMTP malware family to carry out the QuickFox supply chain attack. Although the central CVE is not identified, the attack involves a range of

techniques, including system owner discovery, JavaScript execution, and DLL manipulation. The victimology of the attack is not well-defined, but it is clear that the threat actor is seeking to establish a persistent presence within the targeted systems.

Attack Chain and Priority Control

The observed techniques used in the QuickFox supply chain attack form a complex chain, with the threat actor utilizing various methods to discover system information, inject processes, and modify registry keys. The priority technique in this chain is T1112 Modify Registry, which serves as a critical chokepoint for the attack. To counter this, the lead control is to monitor sensitive registry keys for modification and restrict registry-edit tools for unprivileged users.

Infrastructure and Corroboration

The malicious infrastructure supporting the QuickFox supply chain attack is hosted on providers such as Cloudie Limited, Kaopu Cloud HK Limited, and Alibaba (US) Technology Co. Ltd. According to AbuseIPDB, none of the indicators have reached an 80% confidence level, with the highest confidence seen being 4%. Additionally, abuse.ch has not corroborated any malware families associated with this attack.

Technical Appendix

Ground-truth telemetry from the source pulse; analytical scores are secondary and clearly labelled.

Observed Techniques (ATT&CK, expert-tagged by source)

- T1033 System Owner/User Discovery
- T1059.007 JavaScript
- T1036.005 Match Legitimate Resource Name or Location
- T1574.001 DLL
- T1082 System Information Discovery
- T1140 Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information
- T1055 Process Injection
- T1112 Modify Registry
- T1016 System Network Configuration Discovery
- T1083 File and Directory Discovery
- T1104 Multi-Stage Channels
- T1480 Execution Guardrails
- T1057 Process Discovery
- T1547.001 Registry Run Keys / Startup Folder
- T1571 Non-Standard Port
- T1027 Obfuscated Files or Information
- T1195.002 Compromise Software Supply Chain
- T1518.001 Security Software Discovery

- T1071.001 Web Protocols
- T1105 Ingress Tool Transfer
- T1124 System Time Discovery

Analytical Scores

- Priority technique (graph chokepoint): T1112 Modify Registry (centrality 0.2721).
- Operational risk: High (score 0.636, reaches command-and-control).

Behavioral Signature Cluster

- Method: technique-overlap cosine vs 170 MITRE ATT&CK Groups (top overlap 0.5832; reference threshold $\tau = 0.6$).
- These are behavioural resemblances for defensive playbook cross-referencing, not an identity assessment. Where the source pulse names an actor, that attribution is authoritative; the overlaps below neither confirm nor contest it.

Nearest historical profiles by behavioural overlap (resemblance only):

Historical Profile	Behavioural Overlap
Sidewinder	0.5832
Tropic Trooper	0.5051
Windshift	0.5015
Darkhotel	0.4862
Rocke	0.4543

Enrichment Signal

- Highest AbuseIPDB confidence among IOCs: 4%.

Indicators of Compromise (defanged — non-clickable)

The network and file indicators observed in this activity are listed below for blocklisting:

Type	Indicator	Context
IP	154[.]223[.]58[.]142	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · AS138915 Kaopu Cloud HK Limited
IP	47[.]76[.]92[.]73	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · AS45102 Alibaba (US) Technology Co. Ltd.
IP	202[.]181[.]25[.]71	AbuseIPDB 4% (HK) · AS55933 Cloudie Limited

Type	Indicator	Context
IP	123[.]254[.]106[.]148	AbuseIPDB 0% (HK) · AS55933 Cloudie Limited
IP	103[.]231[.]15[.]135	
IP	103[.]231[.]15[.]219	
IP	103[.]231[.]15[.]248	
IP	103[.]246[.]244[.]20	
IP	123[.]254[.]105[.]38	
IP	154[.]223[.]24[.]158	
IP	154[.]223[.]54[.]159	
IP	154[.]223[.]58[.]64	
IP	154[.]223[.]75[.]206	
IP	170[.]33[.]128[.]5	
IP	202[.]181[.]25[.]73	
IP	38[.]60[.]142[.]56	
IP	43[.]240[.]12[.]34	
IP	43[.]240[.]12[.]35	
IP	45[.]125[.]15[.]100	
IP	45[.]125[.]15[.]104	
IP	45[.]125[.]15[.]111	
IP	45[.]125[.]15[.]114	
IP	45[.]125[.]15[.]115	
IP	45[.]125[.]35[.]225	
Domain	jiejie[.]net	
Domain	www[.]jicloud-cdn[.]net	

Type	Indicator	Context
Domain	cdns3[.]51quickfox[.]cn	
Hash	03fd832b81dd54d2bf5f610a8ff27856	
Hash	19e760ee849eb7c1f100f2b7010a763d	
Hash	1f3031167f94b166cc7b69376a01c124	
Hash	2dd8681dcd218c88d1c78dfe939ec92b	
Hash	2ffdcfb7157511789228988e26d06fd6	
Hash	30d59c3d4916aa5fb24050c6aae7f8e4	
Hash	3b79d95f7f7b58c401a3bc79f94ebb52	
Hash	5e4ed6abbf555e5a542e3d4308ccd7bf	
Hash	5f3daf7417dd666213168eb6c7453cc7	
Hash	b1d344c9a1525373be6a3980fa85a603	
Hash	e0a92209dd62dae8460d934dc6b7ddd7	
Hash	11a6df1e15663ae89f59a9e598ae8987f42a632b	
Hash	173dd4190740b96f6f733c801b6428ed4b52b607	

Reputation by AbuseIPDB · malware attribution by abuse.ch · Geo/ASN data by IP2Location LITE.

Flame Cell // Adversary Pivot [BETA]

BETA. A hypothetical tabletop projection, anchored to documented ATT&CK behaviour and technique co-occurrence across 170 tracked groups. It is not a prediction; treat it as a war-game prompt and review before acting. Spot a pivot that looks wrong? norbert@salacti.com

- **Control applied:** T1112 Modify Registry (persistence)
- **Observed here:** T1112 Modify Registry was the only persistence technique observed in this campaign, so the pivot is projected from cross-actor behaviour.
- **Projected pivot:** T1543 Create or Modify System Process (persistence)
- **Basis:** of the 14+ groups that use Modify Registry, this pairing runs 2.8x above base rate, a disproportionately-coupled move rather than the obvious one.

With T1112 Modify Registry blocked, the threat actor could preserve the same objective by pivoting to T1543 Create or Modify System Process, a technique disproportionately paired with it across tracked groups. Defensive countermeasure: Restrict service/daemon creation to admins; monitor service and driver installs.

Also plausible (same tactic): T1053 Scheduled Task/Job (n=19, lift 1.9), T1505 Server Software Component (n=11, lift 2.0)

Detection and hardening for the pivot (T1543 Create or Modify System Process)

- **Telemetry:** Windows Security / System log; Sysmon
- **Detect:**
 - System 7045 (new service installed); Security 4697 (service installed)
 - Sysmon 1 for sc.exe / services created; unusual ImagePath or user-context services
 - Registry writes under HKLM\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services
- **Harden:**
 - Restrict service creation to admins; application control on service binaries
 - Baseline installed services and alert on new/anomalous ones
- **MITRE:** M1047 Audit, M1028 Operating System Configuration, M1026 Privileged Account Management · DS0019 Service, DS0024 Windows Registry, DS0009 Process